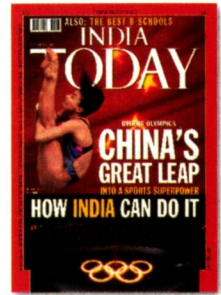


REUTERS



"Beijing Olympics",
September 8, 2008

"China's impressive medal tally in the recent Olympics is indicative of the country's resolve to excel in all fields of development, including sports."

S. LAKSHMI, on e-mail

Chinese Checkers

China achieved Olympic glory through hard work, dedication and discipline displayed by its participants, coaches, officials and administrators ("Beijing Olympics: China's Great Leap Into A Sports Superpower", September 8). For India, the stellar performances by Abhinav Bindra, Sushil Kumar and Vijendra Kumar are exemplary, but too little and too late. The show put up by other smaller nations has put us to shame. Have we done enough to prove our mettle at such a sporting extravaganza? Certainly not. We Indians are still a non-entity in the world of sports. We should accept this truth and do something to change our image from being participants to performers.

VINOD C. DIXIT, on e-mail

India's poor standing at the Olympics doesn't

emanate from dearth of talent, but it stems from dearth of knowledgeable and passionate sports administrators and abundance of politicised sports bodies, mismanaged funds, and coaches who may be good trainers but are feeble mentors. In the final analysis, as Usain Bolt proved, it is the person who matters most rather than the nation. The coaches and trainers should instil self-efficacy, confidence, perseverance and an indomitable will to succeed in our players. These qualities when combined with gaming skills will surely double our chances of success.

Y.G. CHOUKSEY, Pune

China's success story in organising and sweeping the Olympics is mesmerising. If it can perform such a feat being a dictatorship, India, being a democracy, can do even better. It needs to pull

up its socks and give its best shot.

VIRENDRA KUMAR TANGRI,
on e-mail

Poor coaching, bad organisation and lack of money, no doubt, hold India back, and it must get rid of these shortcomings before bidding to host the 2020 Olympics ("How Can India Do It", September 8). Like China which made a great leap in the sporting world, India should learn to invest in individuals rather than just the event.

ROHIT KUMAR, Mumbai

China, the world's most populous country, made giant strides in the global sporting arena with a haul of 51 gold medals at the Beijing Olympics, but if India aims to emulate its success story, there's a lot which needs to be done. Importantly, the fashion in which India hosts the 2010 Common-

wealth Games will speak volumes about its preparedness for all such future sporting events.

DR AVTAR SINGH, Delhi

If economic reforms can transform India into a leading economic power, the administrative reforms can certainly transform India into sporting superpower.

VIJAY DANDIWALA, on e-mail

Third Best

The proposal by the Communist parties to form the Third Front is akin to making castles in the air with no foundation or support ("The Third Affront", September 8). The parties which participate in such parleys are visible only at the regional level with no common agenda, programme or national presence. Their prime intention seems to have an enhanced bargaining power with the Congress while forming the gove-